Bill Bol — Description and Features

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Bill Bol ("speak the bill") is a voice-first phone app for tour and site expense reimbursement. Field staff speak each expense in English, Hindi or Tamil, attach the bill, and submit a signed one-page claim with all invoice copies to their company's Google Sheet and Drive.

Description

The problem. Staff on tours and at project sites spend money every day but claim it late, from memory, with lost or faded bills. Many are not comfortable writing in English. Accountants then chase missing details, match loose bill photos to amounts and classify each line by hand.

Who uses it.

- **Employees:** site supervisors, sales staff, drivers and technicians who record expenses.
- **Employers:** the client businesses that approve and pay the claims.
- **Accountants and CA firms:** they verify and post the claims, and run the database for their clients.

How it works.

1. The employee speaks: "Bus from Chennai to Madurai 450 cash".
2. The app understands the amount, category, date and payment mode, and asks only for what is missing.
3. The employee photographs the bill or attaches a PDF invoice.
4. At the end of the trip they sign once and tap Submit. The app builds a one-page claim form with every bill copy behind it and saves everything to the firm's Google Sheet and Drive. A copy can also go on WhatsApp or email.

Bill Bol installs from a web link on Android and iPhone. It needs no app store or paid server, and works offline.

Features

Area	Feature	Detail
Profile	Profile first	Name, 10-digit mobile and company required before any other screen opens; employee code, designation and email optional
Profile	Setup link	One link from the accountant connects the phone to the firm's sheet and shows the firm's name
Voice entry	Three languages	English, Hindi and Tamil for both speech and the full interface
Voice entry	Understands one sentence	Amount (digits or number words), category, date (today, yesterday, a date), payment mode, place, bus or train route
Voice entry	Asks, never guesses	Spoken and on-screen questions only for missing details; asks "food or room?" for "hotel" and which number is the amount
Voice entry	Keyboard mic fallback	Switches to the phone keyboard's mic where browser voice is blocked (iPhone home-screen apps)
Voice entry	English for the accountant	Writes an English description automatically; the original words are kept for verification
Expense form	Picture categories	12 categories with pictures (food, stay, travel, local, fuel, toll, phone, site material, labour, printing, medicine, other), each mapped to an account head
Expense form	Quick choices	Today, Yesterday or a date; Cash, UPI or Card; shop or place
Bill capture	Camera, gallery, PDF	Phone camera or a live camera window on laptops; several pages per bill; PDF invoices up to 10 MB
Bill capture	No-bill control	A reason (not given, lost, small payment) is required when there is no bill
Claim	One-page claim form	Auto-fits from 14 pt down to 7 pt; entry table with account head and bill reference; total, advance, net payable, amount in words

Area	Feature	Detail
Claim	Accounting	Suggested journal entry: expense heads Dr; advance and reimbursement payable Cr, or refund due Dr
Claim	Controls	Declaration, finger signature, "For accounts use" box, claim number
Claim	Invoice copies inside the PDF	Every photo and PDF invoice page follows the form, labelled B1, B2… with entry, date and amount
Claim	Excel export	Claim, summary and journal sheets
Database	Google Sheet + Drive	Expenses, Claims and Employees sheets; bill copies and claim PDFs in Drive folders by company and employee, linked from the rows
Database	Approval tracking	Status dropdown: Submitted, Checked, Approved, Paid, Rejected; approved by, paid on, remarks
Database	Offline queue	Saves on the phone and uploads automatically when online; status badge shows "All saved" or the number waiting
Sharing	WhatsApp and email	Optional copy through the phone's share sheet; no accountant number needed
App	Install and offline	Installs on Android and iPhone from a link; works without signal
App	Trips and history	Advance per trip, earlier trips with sent or submitted status, edit and delete entries
App	Phone check	Shows what the phone supports and copies a report for support
App	Professional design	Navy and saffron theme, line icons, large text, dark mode, the firm's name on screens and PDF footers

Benefits

For	Benefit
Employee	Claims an expense in under a minute by speaking in their own language; no forms, no English writing; bills cannot be lost once photographed
Employer	Faster, complete claims with a declaration, signature and bill for every rupee; advance adjusted automatically; approval status in one sheet
Accountant / CA firm	Every claim arrives classified by account head with a suggested journal entry and all invoice copies in one PDF; no follow-up calls; one database across all clients

Specifications, security and privacy

Item	Specification
Type	Progressive Web App (installable website)
Devices	Android phones (Chrome), iPhone (Safari), Windows and Mac laptops (Chrome, Edge)
Languages	English, Hindi, Tamil
Built with	HTML, CSS, JavaScript; Google Apps Script; jsPDF, pdf-lib, SheetJS
Database	Google Sheets and Google Drive of the firm
Hosting	Static website on Netlify (free plan) over https
Output	Claim PDF (A4), Excel workbook

- **Data stays with its owner:** entries, bill copies and signatures are stored on the phone and sent only to the firm's own Google Sheet and Drive, or to whoever the employee shares a copy with.
- **No third-party server:** the app has no server of its own; hosting only delivers the app files.

- **Access key:** the Sheet web app accepts uploads only with the firm's access key; staff phones can upload but cannot read the sheet or the Drive folder.
- **Private files:** Drive files stay private to the firm's Google account.
- **Audit trail:** deleted entries are marked, not erased, and resubmitted claims are noted in remarks.

Version and planned enhancements

Current version: **Bill Bol 2.0** (22 October 2026), with profile-first setup, the Google Sheet and Drive database, invoice copies merged into the claim PDF, installable app, and the professional design.

Planned enhancements:

1. Reading amount, date, GSTIN and invoice number from bill photos, with duplicate-bill alerts.
2. An approval view for employers on their phones, with status visible to employees.
3. One-click export of approved claims to Tally and Zoho Books.
4. GST input-credit flag for B2B invoices carrying the company's GSTIN.
5. Expense policy limits per category, with warnings.
6. More languages: Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi.
7. Multi-firm version: separate sheet and key per client, admin dashboard, subscriptions, Play Store listing, DPDP Act consent and data-retention settings.